

Week 7: Environmental Health

JSS3 Intermediate Science — First Term Lesson Note (Deep-Dive Edition)

Introduction

This week explores environmental health — the relationship between the quality of our surroundings and human health — and who is responsible for maintaining a healthy environment.

Meaning and Components

Environmental health refers to all aspects of human health that are determined by physical, chemical, and biological factors in the environment. Its main components include:

Component	Description
Sanitation	Safe disposal of human waste and maintenance of clean surroundings
Clean water supply	Access to water free from harmful contamination
Air quality	Freedom from harmful levels of pollutants in the air
Waste management	Proper collection and disposal of household and industrial waste
Pest and vector control	Managing organisms (like mosquitoes and rodents) that spread disease

Importance of a Clean Environment

A clean environment reduces the spread of disease (such as cholera, malaria, and typhoid), improves quality of life, supports healthy ecosystems, and reduces healthcare costs for individuals and government.

Role of Individuals and Government

Individuals	Government
Dispose of waste properly	Provide waste collection and disposal services
Keep surroundings clean	Enforce environmental sanitation laws
Use safe water sources	Provide clean water infrastructure
Report environmental hazards	Regulate industrial pollution

Environmental Health Officers

Environmental Health Officers are trained professionals responsible for inspecting food premises, water sources, and waste disposal sites; enforcing sanitation regulations; educating communities on hygiene practices; and helping to control disease outbreaks linked to environmental conditions.

Real-Life Application

Many Nigerian communities observe a monthly “sanitation day,” during which residents clean their surroundings — a practical, large-scale example of environmental health practice supported by both individuals and local government.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
Sanitation	Measures for maintaining clean, hygienic conditions
Vector	An organism (such as a mosquito) that transmits disease
Contamination	The presence of unwanted or harmful substances in something

Evaluation Questions

- 1 Define environmental health.
- 2 List three components of environmental health.
- 3 Explain why clean water supply is important for public health.
- 4 What is a “vector,” and give one example?
- 5 Describe two responsibilities of individuals for environmental health.
- 6 Describe two responsibilities of government for environmental health.
- 7 What is the role of an Environmental Health Officer?
- 8 Name one disease that can spread due to poor sanitation.
- 9 Give a real-life example of an environmental health practice in your community.
- 10 In your own words, explain the link between a clean environment and good health.